The implementation of the business logic for Dispatcher Service is almost done. We still need a way to compose the two functions. Based upon our requirements, dispatching an order consists of two steps to be executed in sequence: `pack()` first and `label()` after.

Java provides features to compose `Function` objects in sequence using the `andThen()` or `compose()` operators. The problem is that you can use them only when the output type of the first function is the same as the second function's input. Spring Cloud Function provides a solution to that problem and lets you compose functions seamlessly through transparent type conversion, even between imperative and reactive functions like those we defined earlier.

Composing functions with Spring Cloud is as simple as defining a property in your application.yml (or application.properties) file. Open the application.yml file in your Dispatcher Service project, and configure Spring Cloud Function to manage and compose the `pack()` and `label()` functions as follows.

Listing 10.9 Declaring the functions managed by Spring Cloud

```
spring:
  cloud:
    function:
      definition: pack|label    ❶
```

❶ Definition of the function managed by Spring Cloud Function

The `spring.cloud.function.definition` property lets you declare which functions you want Spring Cloud Function to manage and integrate, resulting in a specific data flow. In the previous section, we implemented the basic `pack()` and `label()` functions. Now we can